Allen Key



Category: **Hand Tools - Fastening & Gripping** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 22 labs

Covers these lab items: Allen key set; Allen key set (Insulated); Allen wrench; Allen Wrench Set; Allen Wrench Set (Hex Set)

What it is used for

An Allen key tightens or loosens fasteners with hexagonal socket heads. Select the correct key size and use it carefully to prevent rounding the socket or damaging the tool.

How to use

1. Inspect the Allen key for bending, worn ends, rust, or damage.
2. Select the correct size that fits fully into the hexagonal socket.
3. Clean the fastener socket if dirt prevents proper engagement.
4. Insert the key fully and keep it aligned with the fastener.
5. Turn the key smoothly with controlled force and avoid excessive leverage.
6. Stop if the key slips or the socket begins to round off.
7. Remove the key and return it to the correct set after use.

⚠ Safety

- Do not use a bent or worn Allen key.
- Avoid adding an unapproved extension to increase leverage.
- Keep fingers clear of pinch points and sharp workpiece edges.
- Use insulated keys for electrical tasks only when correctly rated and inspected.

Care & storage

- Wipe keys clean and dry after use.
- Store the set in an organised holder and replace worn or damaged keys.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.